

VERIFIED ≠ VALUABLE

What 8,782 startups with machine-verified revenue
reveal about the build-in-public economy

TrustMRR · full dataset · frozen 30 Jul 2026

8,782

startups

117

countries

\$33.2M

verified 30-day revenue

\$137M

listed for sale

The screenshot era ended. A subtler problem began.

Founders connect a read-only payment API key. Nothing is self-reported. So what does honesty actually show us?



What it fixed

Fake MRR screenshots. Every figure is pulled directly from Stripe, RevenueCat, Dodo Payments, Polar and 4 more providers — hourly.



What it exposed

A revenue distribution so extreme that the median listed startup earns nothing at all, in any given month.

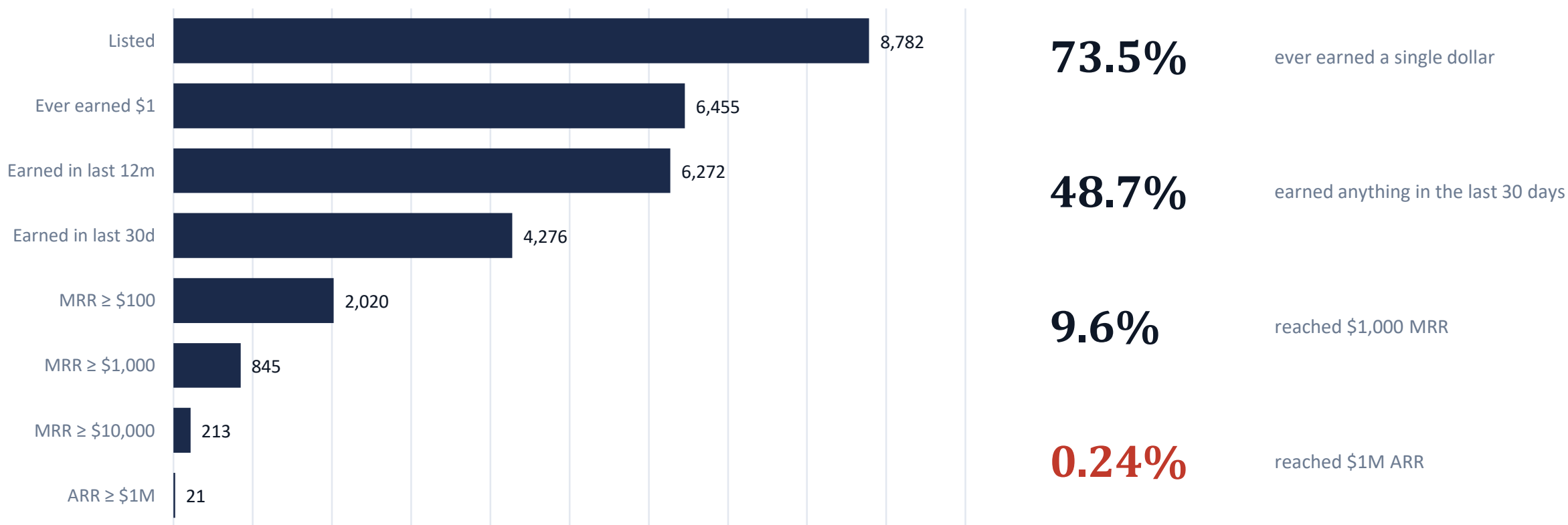


What it still hides

A headline valuation multiple built on the wrong denominator — and 46% of for-sale listings whose badge reads 0.0x.

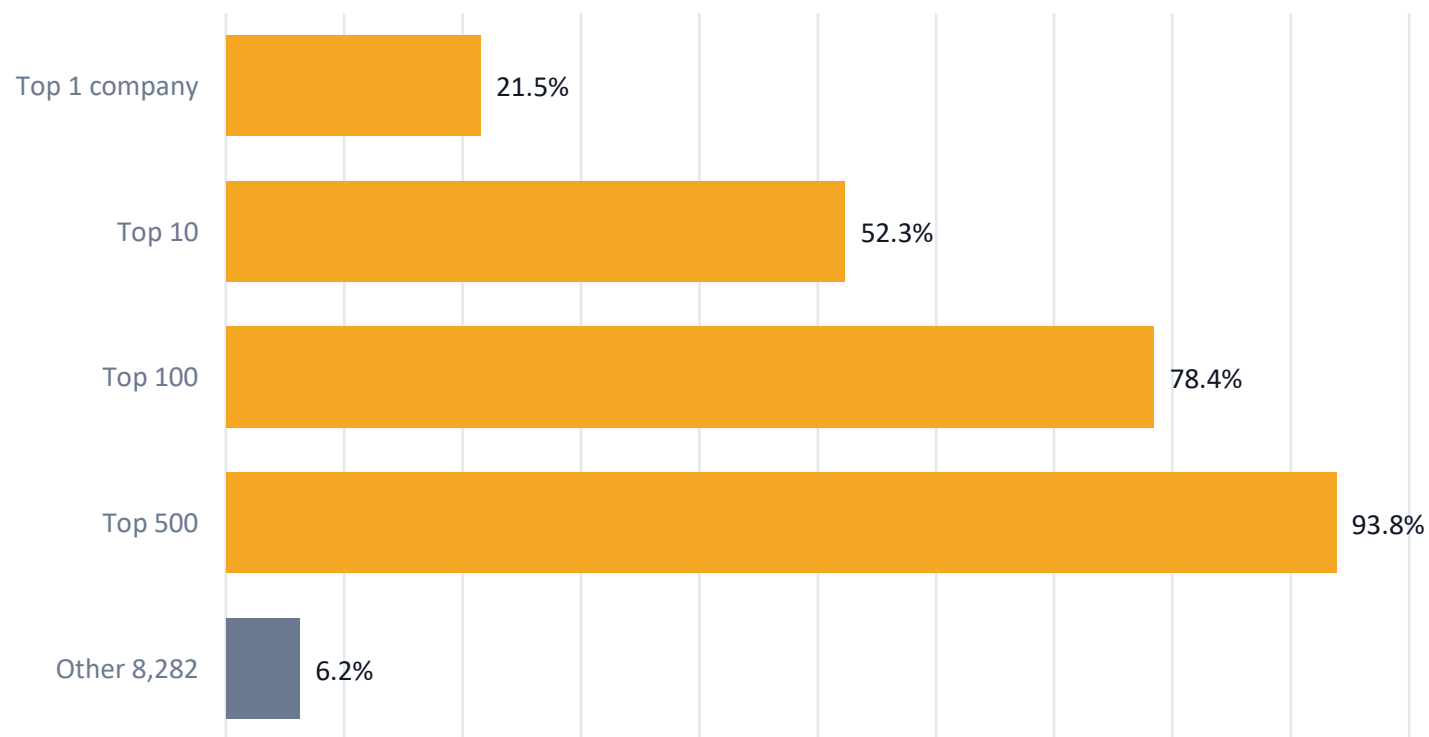
Only 21 of 8,782 startups reached \$1M ARR.

Each step is harder than the last. Half the directory earned nothing at all in the last 30 days.



One company is a fifth of the entire economy.

A Gini coefficient of 0.975 — more unequal than the income distribution of any country on earth.



0.975

Gini coefficient of verified 30-day revenue

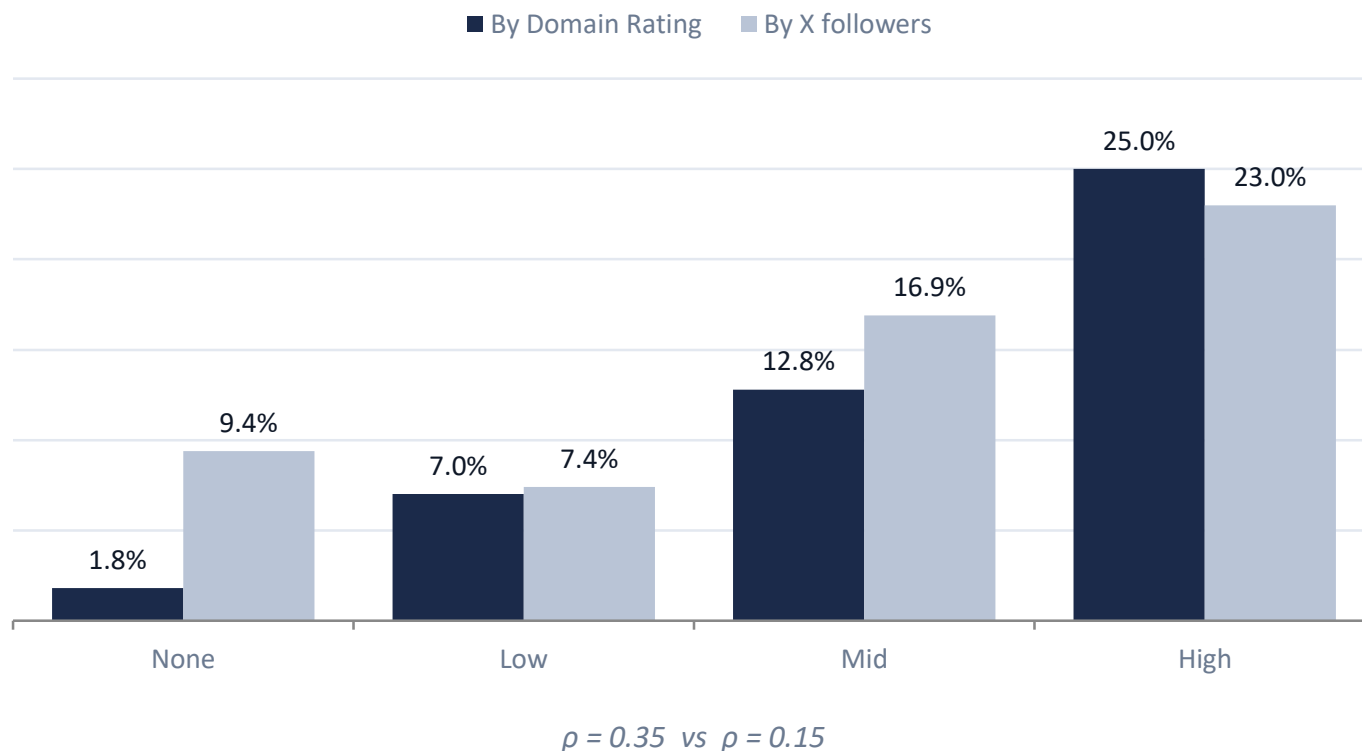
\$0

Median 30-day revenue AND median MRR across all 8,782 listings

Cumulative share of \$33.2M total verified last-30-day revenue.

Distribution pays. Audience mostly doesn't.

Odds of crossing \$1,000 MRR, cut by owned distribution (Domain Rating) versus borrowed attention (X followers).



Recurring beats lifetime

13% of subscription products cross \$1k MRR. Only 4% of lifetime / one-time products do — their median MRR is \$0.

B2B beats B2C on price

Median ARPU: \$29 for B2B versus \$8.37 for B2C. Same build effort, 3.5x the revenue per customer.

India builds the second-most. It earns the least per build.

807 Indian startups — 9.2% of every company listed — produce 0.7% of all verified revenue.

807

Indian startups listed
(2nd only to the US)

0.7%

share of global verified
30-day revenue

\$282

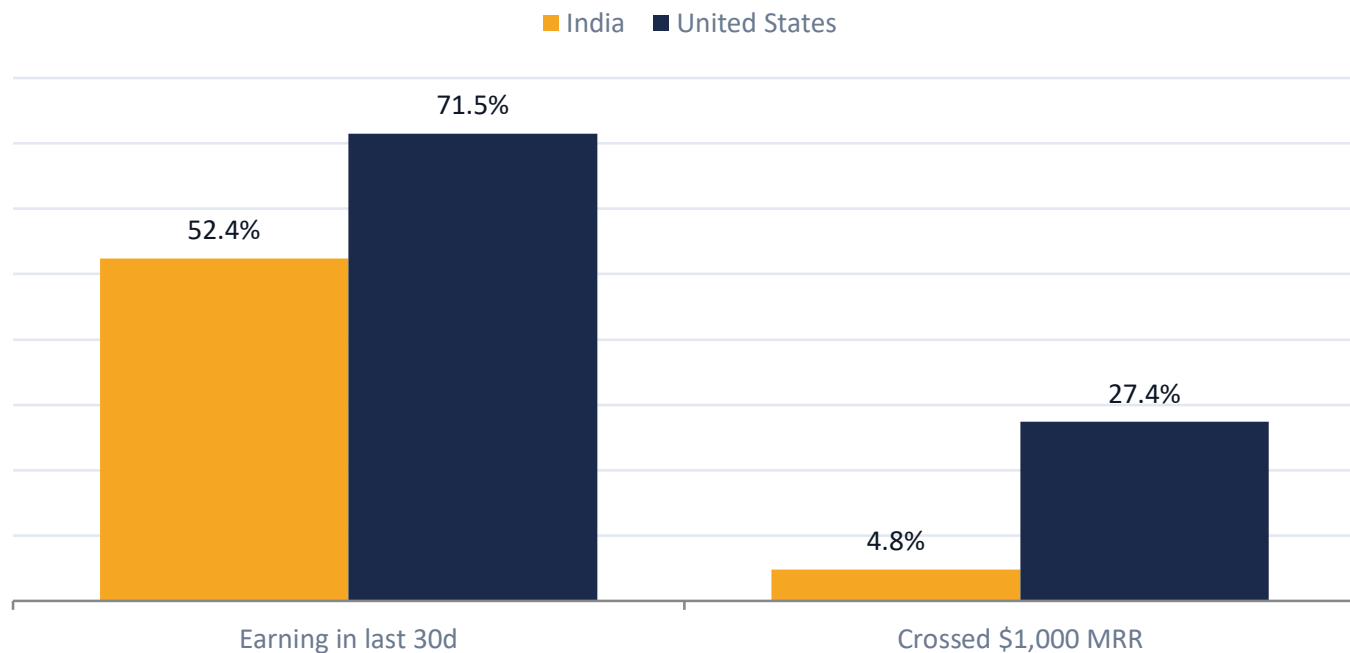
revenue per company
vs \$12,455 in the US

But the honest read is not that India builds badly. It is that India builds recently — and prices timidly.

76.5% of Indian listings earned 100% of their all-time revenue within the last 12 months (US: 61.1%), and 548 of the 807 arrived through Dodo Payments — a young, India-first cohort.

The gap that survives every control: attention without conversion.

Comparing only companies with more than 500 X followers — equal attention, radically unequal outcomes.



Same audience size. 5.7x the conversion.

What is actually missing

Price

Median ARPU \$12 vs \$20. Median entry price \$12 vs \$15.

Distribution

Median Domain Rating 2 vs 4. 34% of Indian products have zero SEO authority.

Buyer

Only 26.5% sell B2B — the segment with 3.5x the ARPU.

The marketplace multiple is built on 30 days of revenue.

We reverse-engineered the badge against five possible denominators. Only one fits.

Denominator tested	Correlation	Exact match
Trailing 12-month revenue	-0.06	10%
Last 30 days × 12	0.994	98%
MRR × 12	0.45	35%
Last 3 months × 4	0.48	30%
All-time revenue	-0.10	9%

So what?

3.6x

median multiple the platform displays

6.95x

median multiple against real trailing 12-month revenue

Buyers anchoring on the badge are reading a price roughly 2x cheaper than it is.

Spearman correlation between the displayed revenue_multiple and asking price divided by each denominator. n = 1,939 priced listings.

Nearly half the shop window is empty.

1,939 companies carry an asking price totalling \$137M. Here is what a buyer is really browsing.

45%

of for-sale listings earned ZERO revenue in the last 30 days

46%

display a multiple of "0.0x" — the badge is undefined for them

355

have never earned a single dollar, ever — median ask \$1,500

Why list a product that earns nothing?

A TrustMRR profile grants a dofollow backlink. 2,327 listings have never earned a dollar — 95% of them still registered a website, and their median Domain Rating is 0. For a large slice of this directory, the product is not the business. The listing is the marketing.

So what?

Three conclusions the verified data supports — and one it does not.

For founders **Stop optimising the audience. Optimise the denominator.**

Domain Rating moves the odds of \$1k MRR 14x; followers move them 2.4x. Recurring pricing triples the odds versus lifetime deals.

For India **The constraint is monetisation design, not engineering talent.**

Equal attention, 5.7x worse conversion. \$12 ARPU against \$20. The build layer is solved; the pricing and distribution layers are not.

For buyers **Recompute every multiple before you believe it.**

The displayed badge annualises 30 days. Against real trailing revenue the median listing is 6.95x, not 3.6x.

The limit: this is a self-selected directory, not a census. It proves what these 8,782 businesses earn — not what all startups earn.